ZERO TRUST SECURITY

ZERO TRUST ARCHITECTURE

Never trust, always verify. In a Zero Trust model, nothing inside or outside the network is trusted by default. Every access request is authenticated and authorised. Network location is not a security boundary — identity is. This limits blast radius when credentials are compromised.

KEY BENEFITS

- ✓ Dramatically limits lateral movement if credentials are stolen
- ✓ Removes implicit trust in VPN or internal network location
- ✓ Short-lived tokens mean stolen credentials expire quickly
- ✓ Every access attempt is logged — providing a complete forensic trail

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

Google's BeyondCorp initiative, launched after the Aurora breach in 2009, moved all access controls from network perimeters to identity-based verification. It became the blueprint for Zero Trust architecture.

PRACTICAL EXAMPLE

An engineer's laptop is compromised. Because every service requires a short-lived token from the identity provider, the attacker cannot pivot. Blast radius is limited to the engineer's own permissions — not the entire VPN subnet.

REFLECTION QUESTION

If an attacker obtained valid credentials for one service, how far could they move through your system?